

TEMPLE ARCHITECTURE AND CHANDELLA KHAJURAHO

TEMPLE RITUAL SEQUENCE → REGIONAL MORPHOLOGY → KHAJURAHO POWER-TO-FORM → KHAJURAHO AXIAL CHAIN → MOUNTAIN SILHOUETTE → BREADTH-OF-LIFE LEDGER

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • active generation g1 • explicit approval of this exact generation is required • all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

00

STAGE 00

TEMPLE RITUAL SEQUENCE

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ELEVATED SACRED PLATFORM

CONGREGATIONAL APPROACH

TRANSITION TO SANCTUM

DEITY AND RITUAL FOCUS

JAGATI → elevated sacred platform

MANDAPA → congregational approach

ANTARALA → transition to sanctum

GARBHAGRIHA → deity and ritual focus

CORE CLAIM

- JAGATI → elevated sacred platform
- MANDAPA → congregational approach

MECHANISM

- ANTARALA → transition to sanctum
- GARBHAGRIHA → deity and ritual focus

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- JAGATI → elevated sacred platform
- MANDAPA → congregational approach

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: ANTARALA → transition to sanctum; GARBHAGRIHA → deity and ritual focus.

01

STAGE 01

REGIONAL MORPHOLOGY

REGIONAL MORPHOLOGY

CURVILINEAR SHIKHARA

TIERED VIMANA AND ENCLOSURE

SELECTIVE NORTHERN-SOUTHERN GRAMMAR

BRICK, TERRACOTTA AND BANGLA ROOF

CORE CLAIM

- NAGARA → curvilinear shikhara
- DRAVIDA → tiered vimana and enclosure

MECHANISM

- DECCAN → selective northern-southern grammar
- EASTERN → brick, terracotta and Bangla roof

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- NAGARA → curvilinear shikhara
- DRAVIDA → tiered vimana and enclosure

CORE CLAIM

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02

STAGE 02

KHAJURAHO POWER-TO-FORM

KHAJURAHO POWER-TO-FORM

CHANELLA ASSERTION

VISIBLE PATRONAGE NEED

MAHARAJADHIRAJA CONTEXT

TEMPLE CLUSTER

SOVEREIGNTY IN STONE

NO INVENTED VICTORY DEDICATION

CHANELLA ASSERTION → visible patronage need

DHANGA → maharajadhiraja context

TEMPLE CLUSTER → sovereignty in stone

LIMIT → no invented victory dedication

CORE CLAIM

- CHANELLA ASSERTION → visible patronage need
- DHANGA → maharajadhiraja context

MECHANISM

- TEMPLE CLUSTER → sovereignty in stone
- LIMIT → no invented victory dedication

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- CHANELLA ASSERTION → visible patronage need
- DHANGA → maharajadhiraja context

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: TEMPLE CLUSTER → sovereignty in stone; LIMIT → no invented victory dedication.

03

STAGE 03

KHAJURAHO AXIAL CHAIN

KHAJURAHO AXIAL CHAIN

ENTRANCE PORCH

GARBHAGRIHA + SHIKHARA

SACRED CLIMAX

ARDHAMANDAPA → entrance porch

MANDAPA → hall

ANTARALA → vestibule

GARBHAGRIHA + SHIKHARA → sacred climax

CORE CLAIM

- ARDHAMANDAPA → entrance porch
- MANDAPA → hall

MECHANISM

- ANTARALA → vestibule
- GARBHAGRIHA + SHIKHARA → sacred climax

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- ARDHAMANDAPA → entrance porch
- MANDAPA → hall

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: ANTARALA → vestibule; GARBHAGRIHA + SHIKHARA → sacred climax.

03

CORE CLAIM

- CHANELLA ASSERTION → visible patronage need
- DHANGA → maharajadhiraja context

MECHANISM

- TEMPLE CLUSTER → sovereignty in stone
- LIMIT → no invented victory dedication

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- CHANELLA ASSERTION → visible patronage need
- DHANGA → maharajadhiraja context

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: TEMPLE CLUSTER → sovereignty in stone; LIMIT → no invented victory dedication.

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MANDAPA → hall

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ANTARALA → vestibule

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CORE CLAIM

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MECHANISM

- ANTARALA → vestibule
- GARBHAGRIHA + SHIKHARA → sacred climax

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- ARDHAMANDAPA → entrance porch
- MANDAPA → hall

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: ANTARALA → vestibule; GARBHAGRIHA + SHIKHARA → sacred climax.

04

STAGE 04

MOUNTAIN SILHOUETTE

MOUNTAIN SILHOUETTE

MAIN SHIKHARA

CENTRAL VERTICAL MASS

CLUSTERED REPLICA SPIRES

RAISED HORIZONTAL BASE

MOUNTAIN-RANGE COMPOSITION

URUSHRINGAS → clustered replica spires

→

JAGATI → raised horizontal base

→

RESULT → mountain-range composition

CORE CLAIM

- MAIN SHIKHARA → central vertical mass
- URUSHRINGAS → clustered replica spires

MECHANISM

- JAGATI → raised horizontal base
- RESULT → mountain-range composition

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- MAIN SHIKHARA → central vertical mass
- URUSHRINGAS → clustered replica spires

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: JAGATI → raised horizontal base; RESULT → mountain-range composition.

05

STAGE 05

BREADTH-OF-LIFE LEDGER

BREADTH-OF-LIFE LEDGER

DEITIES AND WORSHIPPERS

TEACHERS, DANCERS AND MUSICIANS

VYALAS AND NARRATIVE FORMS

MAITHUNA AS ONE REGISTER

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
SACRED → deities and worshippers	IMAGINATIVE → vyalas and narrative forms	SACRED → deities and worshippers
SOCIAL → teachers, dancers and musicians	INTIMATE → maithuna as one register	SOCIAL → teachers, dancers and musicians

CORE CLAIM

- SACRED → deities and worshippers
- SOCIAL → teachers, dancers and musicians

MECHANISM

- IMAGINATIVE → vyalas and narrative forms
- INTIMATE → maithuna as one register

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- SACRED → deities and worshippers
- SOCIAL → teachers, dancers and musicians

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: IMAGINATIVE → vyalas and narrative forms; INTIMATE → maithuna as one register.

06

STAGE 06

CHAUSATH YOGINI DISTINCTION

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CHANDELLA LANDSCAPE

KHAJURAHO FORM

OPEN-AIR GRANITE ENCLOSURE

NEAR MORENA, KACHCHHAPAGHATA

MITAOLI FORM

CIRCULAR; POPULAR PARLIAMENT LINK

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
KHAJURAHO → Chandella landscape	MITAOLI → near Morena, Kachchhapaghata	KHAJURAHO → Chandella landscape
KHAJURAHO FORM → open-air granite enclosure	MITAOLI FORM → circular; popular Parliament link	KHAJURAHO FORM → open-air granite enclosure

CORE CLAIM

- KHAJURAHO → Chandella landscape
- KHAJURAHO FORM → open-air granite enclosure

MECHANISM

- MITAOLI → near Morena, Kachchhapaghata
- MITAOLI FORM → circular; popular Parliament link

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- KHAJURAHO → Chandella landscape
- KHAJURAHO FORM → open-air granite enclosure

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06

CORE CLAIM

- SACRED → deities and worshippers
- SOCIAL → teachers, dancers and musicians

MECHANISM

- IMAGINATIVE → vyalas and narrative forms
- INTIMATE → maithuna as one register

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- SACRED → deities and worshippers
- SOCIAL → teachers, dancers and musicians

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: IMAGINATIVE → vyalas and narrative forms; INTIMATE → maithuna as one register.

06

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CORE CLAIM

- KHAJURAHO → Chandella landscape
- KHAJURAHO FORM → open-air granite enclosure

MECHANISM

- MITAOLI → near Morena, Kachchhapaghata
- MITAOLI FORM → circular; popular Parliament link

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- KHAJURAHO → Chandella landscape
- KHAJURAHO FORM → open-air granite enclosure

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: MITAOLI → near Morena, Kachchhapaghata; MITAOLI FORM → circular; popular Parliament link.

07

STAGE 07

PALLAVA TRANSITION

PALLAVA TRANSITION

ROCK-CUT MANDAPAS

MONOLITHIC PANCHA RATHAS

STRUCTURAL SHORE TEMPLE

CHOLA STRUCTURAL EXPANSION

MAHENDRAVARMAN → rock-cut mandapas

MAMALLA → monolithic Pancha Rathas

RAJASIMHA → structural Shore Temple

LEGACY → Chola structural expansion

CORE CLAIM

- MAHENDRAVARMAN → rock-cut mandapas
- MAMALLA → monolithic Pancha Rathas

MECHANISM

- RAJASIMHA → structural Shore Temple
- LEGACY → Chola structural expansion

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- MAHENDRAVARMAN → rock-cut mandapas
- MAMALLA → monolithic Pancha Rathas

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RAJASIMHA → structural Shore Temple; LEGACY → Chola structural expansion.

08

STAGE 08

CHOLA ACHIEVEMENT SYSTEM

CHOLA ACHIEVEMENT SYSTEM

GRANITE TEMPLE

MONUMENTAL STATE FORM

BRONZE + MURAL

PORTABLE AND PAINTED ART

ADMINISTRATION AND PATRONAGE

LIVING WORSHIP

CONTINUING CULTURAL MEMORY

GRANITE TEMPLE → monumental state form

BRONZE + MURAL → portable and painted art

INSCRIPTION → administration and patronage

LIVING WORSHIP → continuing cultural memory

CORE CLAIM

- GRANITE TEMPLE → monumental state form
- BRONZE + MURAL → portable and painted art

MECHANISM

- INSCRIPTION → administration and patronage
- LIVING WORSHIP → continuing cultural memory

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- GRANITE TEMPLE → monumental state form
- BRONZE + MURAL → portable and painted art

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: BRONZE + MURAL → portable and painted art.

09

STAGE 09

DECCAN EXPERIMENT

DECCAN EXPERIMENT

PATTADAKAL VIRUPAKSHA

DRAVIDA TOWER

PATTADAKAL PAPANATHA

NAGARA TOWER

STELLATE SOAPSTONE DENSITY

DESCRIBE EVIDENCE BEFORE VESARA

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
PATTADAKAL VIRUPAKSHA → Dravida tower	HOYSALA → stellate soapstone density	PATTADAKAL VIRUPAKSHA → Dravida tower
PATTADAKAL PAPANATHA → Nagara tower	VERDICT → describe evidence before Vesara	PATTADAKAL PAPANATHA → Nagara tower

CORE CLAIM

- PATTADAKAL VIRUPAKSHA → Dravida tower
- PATTADAKAL PAPANATHA → Nagara tower

MECHANISM

- HOYSALA → stellate soapstone density
- VERDICT → describe evidence before Vesara

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- PATTADAKAL VIRUPAKSHA → Dravida tower
- PATTADAKAL PAPANATHA → Nagara tower

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: HOYSALA → stellate soapstone density; VERDICT → describe evidence before Vesara.

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09

STAGE 09

DECCAN EXPERIMENT

DECCAN EXPERIMENT

PATTADAKAL VIRUPAKSHA

DRAVIDA TOWER

PATTADAKAL PAPANATHA

NAGARA TOWER

STELLATE SOAPSTONE DENSITY

DESCRIBE EVIDENCE BEFORE VESARA

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PATTADAKAL VIRUPAKSHA → Dravida tower	HOYSALA → stellate soapstone density	PATTADAKAL VIRUPAKSHA → Dravida tower
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CORE CLAIM

- PATTADAKAL VIRUPAKSHA → Dravida tower
- PATTADAKAL PAPANATHA → Nagara tower

MECHANISM

- HOYSALA → stellate soapstone density
- VERDICT → describe evidence before Vesara

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- PATTADAKAL VIRUPAKSHA → Dravida tower
- PATTADAKAL PAPANATHA → Nagara tower

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: HOYSALA → stellate soapstone density; VERDICT → describe evidence before Vesara.

10

STAGE 10

LATE DRAVIDA SHIFT

LATE DRAVIDA SHIFT

VIMANA-DOMINANT IMPERIAL COMPLEX

RAYA GOPURAM AND MANDAPAS

GRADED GATEWAYS AND PRAKARAMS

PROCESSION, GATHERING AND RITUAL EXPANSION

CHOLA → vimana-dominant imperial complex

VIJAYANAGARA → raya gopuram and mandapas

NAYAKA → graded gateways and prakarams

FUNCTION → procession, gathering and ritual expansion

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
CHOLA → vimana-dominant imperial complex	NAYAKA → graded gateways and prakarams	CHOLA → vimana-dominant imperial complex
VIJAYANAGARA → raya gopuram and mandapas	FUNCTION → procession, gathering and ritual expansion	VIJAYANAGARA → raya gopuram and mandapas

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: NAYAKA → graded gateways and prakarams; FUNCTION → procession, gathering and ritual expansion.

11

STAGE 11

TEMPLE ANSWER SPINE

TEMPLE ANSWER SPINE

SCHOOL, DYNASTY AND MONUMENT

PLAN, TOWER, MATERIAL AND ENCLOSURE

PATRONAGE, SCULPTURE AND SOCIETY

COMPARISON, SOURCE LIMIT AND STATUS

NAME → school, dynasty and monument

DESCRIBE → plan, tower, material and enclosure

ANALYSE → patronage, sculpture and society

QUALIFY → comparison, source limit and status

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
NAME → school, dynasty and monument	ANALYSE → patronage, sculpture and society	NAME → school, dynasty and monument
DESCRIBE → plan, tower, material and enclosure	QUALIFY → comparison, source limit and status	DESCRIBE → plan, tower, material and enclosure

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: ANALYSE → patronage, sculpture and society; QUALIFY → comparison, source limit and status.

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT

UNESCO'S KHAJURAHO GROUP OF MONUMENTS PROPERTY REMAINS INSCRIBED

PRESENTING MITHUNA/EROTIC SCULPTURE AS UNIQUE TO KHAJURAHO. - THE

TREATING EVERY KHAJURAHO TEMPLE'S ORIENTATION, SCALE OR DEDICATION AS

CONFUSING THE NUMBER OF SURVIVING KHAJURAHO TEMPLES WITH THE

ATTRIBUTING A SPECIFIC NAMED TEMPLE TO A SPECIFIC CHANDELLA

REPEATING THE TEXTBOOK'S CIRCULAR-PLAN DESCRIPTION FOR KHAJURAHO'S

TREATING "VESARA" AS A SETTLED, SELF-EXPLANATORY CATEGORY. - USE

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH	ATTRIBUTION / INTERPRETIVE LIMIT	COMPARATIVE HERITAGE NUANCE
UNESCO's Khajuraho Group of Monuments property remains inscribed	NOT: Attributing a specific named temple to a specific Chandella ruler	NOT: Medieval History owns the detailed Chandella-Pratihara-Pala
NOT: Presenting mithuna/erotic sculpture as unique to Khajuraho. - The	NOT: Repeating the textbook's circular-plan description for Khajuraho's	NOT: Society/Gender Studies owns a doctrinal or normative reading of
NOT: Treating every Khajuraho temple's orientation, scale or dedication as	NOT: Treating "Vesara" as a settled, self-explanatory category. - Use it	CAUTION: Conservation, tourism and integrity trade-off (examiner angle):
NOT: Confusing the number of surviving Khajuraho temples with the current	NOT: Silently normalising "Chandella" to "Chandela" (or vice versa) when	Cross-links: Topic 06 (sculptural technique/iconographic reading)

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.